ILR School

Policy 1.3

Volume: Financial Management
Chapter: Petty Cash
Responsible Office: Financial Operations & Budget Planning
Originally Issued: October 2011
Last Full Review: October 2011
Last Updated: November 2024
Expiration: November 2026

Industrial Labor & Relations
Petty Cash Policy

Policy Statement
The Industrial and Labor Relations School ("ILR") provides advances of cash in limited circumstances to meet the business needs of the school. University policy 3.21, Advances (Including Petty Cash and Accounts Receivable) establishes the circumstances and procedures for making such advances while ILR Policy 1.3, Petty Cash further defines and restricts the petty cash process for ILR.

Reason for Policy
This policy was created to establish clear guidelines for use of Petty Cash.

Entities Affected by this Policy
All units of ILR.

Related Resources

Advances (Including Petty Cash and Accounts Receivable) | University Policy
Safekeeping of Financial Assets, Including Cash, Checks, and Securities | University Policy
Business Expenses | University Policy
Procurement of Goods and Services | University Policy

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Overview

The preferred purchasing method for small-dollar business expenses is by procurement card. Typically, small-dollar expenses are less than $40. The process below is applicable when reimbursement is sought for expenses paid with personal funds. When using a procurement card is not possible, using funds from petty cash for qualifying, small-dollar expenses, or reimbursements is appropriate.

Process

Faculty/Staff/Students

- Receives verbal approval to initiate purchase from “account owner”.
- Purchases goods/services with personal funds and obtains a detailed receipt from the vendor.
- Submits receipt to Accounts Receivable & Cash Management Coordinator, Tara Kastenhuber (tk643@cornell.edu), to receive reimbursement from Petty Cash.
- The receipt must contain the account number, date, business purpose, name of individual receiving the reimbursement and the amount.

Office of Financial Operations and Budget Planning

- If the amount of the reimbursement is $40 or less, the person will receive the reimbursement immediately (if Petty Cash funds permit).
- If the amount of the reimbursement is greater than $40, the department will need to send the receipt to the FTC for reimbursement through a Disbursement Voucher.